

# Tiv Festivals Arrangement for Archive Seeding

## 1. Kyegh Sha Shwa Cultural Festival

**Period:** December

**Type:** Food and Cultural Festival

**Location:** Makurdi, Benue State

**Description:** An annual large-scale Tiv cultural gathering held in Makurdi. It celebrates Tiv heritage through traditional food, music, and dance. The festival is especially associated with *Nyamkyegh sha shwa*, a chicken and beniseed dish.

**Key Cultural Elements:** Traditional Tiv food, cultural dances, music performances, community gathering.

## 2. Kwagh-Hir Puppet Festival

**Period:** December – April

**Type:** Dramatic / Performance Festival

**Location:** Tiv communities, especially in Benue State

**Description:** A renowned Tiv dramatic folk theatre tradition that uses puppets, marionettes, masquerades, music, and storytelling. It presents themes of social conflict, history, morality, and community ethics.

**Key Cultural Elements:** Puppetry, marionettes, masquerades, storytelling, music, drama.

## 3. Tiv Day Celebration

**Period:** Annual

**Type:** Cultural Unity and Identity Festival

**Location:** Often held in Gboko and major cities such as Lagos

**Description:** A major annual celebration that brings Tiv people together to celebrate their shared identity, culture, and heritage. It commonly features traditional attire, dance, storytelling, and cultural discussions.

**Key Cultural Elements:** A'nger attire, Swange dance, storytelling, cultural lectures/discussions, community reunion.

## 4. Ivom Dance Festival

**Period:** Not specifically fixed

**Type:** Dance and Cultural Renewal Festival

**Location:** Tiv communities

**Description:** A traditional Tiv festival centered on the Ivom dance. It promotes cultural renewal, celebration, and the preservation of Tiv dance aesthetics and performance traditions.

**Key Cultural Elements:** Ivom dance, cultural performance, celebration, renewal of tradition.

## 5. Akata Fishing Festival

**Period:** March – May

**Type:** Fishing and Communal Festival

**Location:** Katsina-Ala

**Description:** A traditional fishing festival held in Katsina-Ala that showcases local fishing skills and techniques. It attracts participants and competitors from Tiv, Etulo, and Jukun communities.

**Key Cultural Elements:** Fishing competition, traditional fishing methods, inter-community participation, celebration of riverine livelihood.

## 6. Biem and Toho Yilan

**Period:** December – April

**Type:** Hunting Festival

**Location:** Tiv communities

**Description:** A traditional Tiv hunting festival involving both inter-clan hunting expeditions (Biem) and intra-clan hunting expeditions (Toho Yilan). These are usually accompanied by cultural dances and communal celebration.

**Key Cultural Elements:** Hunting expeditions, clan participation, cultural dances, communal celebration.

## 7. Nyinya Festival

**Period:** Not specifically fixed

**Type:** Wealth / Social Status Celebration

**Location:** Tiv communities

**Description:** A traditional celebration of affluence in which a person who acquires a horse, a symbol of wealth and prestige, hosts a feast for their age group. The event is marked by praise songs, feasting, and traditional dance performances.

**Key Cultural Elements:** Horse symbolism, feast, praise songs, traditional dancers, age-group celebration.

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## Core Cultural Elements Associated with Tiv Festivals

**Attire:** A'nger – the black-and-white striped Tiv fabric symbolizing earth and resilience (black), and peace and purity (white).

**Music and Dance:** Swange – a popular Tiv social dance performed with rhythmic, graceful circular movement.

**Food:** Ruam kumen (pounded yam) and Nyamkyegh sha shwa (chicken and beniseed dish).